

Tabloid TECH

People And Events That Grabbed The Headlines—For Better Or For Worse

It Kills The Mind

In general, people think the Internet is here to stay. They seem to like it. Yes, there are people who say the Internet is good. John, Sir Elton, is not one of them. This Sir-bloke hates the Internet—



he can't wait to go back to the good old days when the Big Network was only for the boffins and geeks in universities.

So here's his reason: there has been a surfeit of technology, and this has made people too lazy. The Internet is creating a lot of mediocre stuff, which is good most of the time, but that it is hampering the creation of masterpieces.

Never a man to rant about a problem without suggesting a solution, the admittedly talented musician says the only solution is to shut down the Internet for five years and see what sort of stuff is created then. Food for thought, is our only comment. (Who knows?)

Eminem Raps Apple

Marshall Mathers II—better known as Eminem the wannabe nigga—recently sued Apple for featuring one of his tracks in an iTunes Store ad without consent. In the ad, aired on MTV (who is also facing the music), Eminem's *Lose Yourself* was belted out by a ten-year-old. (White, black, or confused, we don't know.) Now the record company that owns the copyrights—Eight Mile Style, if you really

want to know—is crying foul on behalf of the “Wigger”—and claiming about \$10 million in damages. There were efforts to settle the deal out of court, but, etc. etc. and now both sides are readying themselves for a court battle. Incidentally, a number of Eminem's tracks are available for sale on the iTunes store, and that's another legal matter.

Apple has had run-ins with the music industry earlier (pardon us for insinuating that Eminem's stuff is music). They was sued twice by the Beatles' music label Apple Corp. for using its name. Then there have been the law-suits relating to restricting iTunes music to iPods only... litigators just seem to love the company. But it's reciprocal. Let's not get into that.



We Don't Need No Censors

Pearl Jam hates Dubya. And in case people doubt it, they make their distaste amply clear through lyrics like “George Bush leave this world alone” and “George Bush find yourself another home.” Problem is, nobody heard them—those lyrics were edited out. This happened during a

cybercast of a Pearl Jam concert hosted on an AT&T Web site. The company later apologised in pleading tones; they said a subcontractor was responsible for what had happened. Come on out, conspiracy theorists and free speech advocates—tell us about what politics went into this. We can't figure.

Wallpaper Woman Wields Wiimote



Recognise the picture? That's Jessica Alba. She's featured on your wallpaper at some point or the other—if you're a reasonably red-blooded male, that is. If you aren't—or if you're female—you'll need a line of an introduction: Ms Alba is an actress. She starred in *Fantastic Four*, *Dark Angel*, and other movies. In addition, Jessica the natural brunette (!) has been dubbed the sexiest woman in the Milky Way or some such epithet by practically all the authorities out there: *FHM*, *Maxim*, *AskMen.com*, and even *Playboy*. Which is over the top—she's just a good-looking woman, especially on wallpapers.

Then, someone seems to have done body scans of her (and why not?), and characters that look just like her (she's said this is “completely cool

and bizarre”) have been spotted on the games based on those movies.

But Ms Alba hasn't just been featured (in a sense) in games, she also plays them. Quite a bit, apparently. She loves the Nintendo DS, and now, the Wii. Body movements translate into movements in the game, see? So that's her exercise plan... As a matter of fact, her favourite is *Wii Sports*, which includes baseball and tennis games; an hour of this at the Wii burns quite a few calories.

Women gamers are hard to come by, and celebrity gamers are hard to come by, too. Now take the two and you have a woman celebrity gamer—rare indeed!

Seriously, it's refreshing to see a body-based celebrity whose first and last attribute is not the curves.